Borano Llana

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Education

University of Rhode Island, Rhode Island, USA
PhD in Computer Science — *Expected: May 2027*
University of Rhode Island, Rhode Island, USA
MS in Computer Science — *May 2025*
American University in Bulgaria, Bulgaria
BA in Computer Science, Software Engineering Concentration — *May 2021*

Experience

Graduate Research

Publications:

- **CHI '25**
  "Priming at Scale: An Evaluation of Using AI to Generate Primes for Mobile Readers"
- **VSS '25**
  "Typography and Pupillometry: Exploring Reading Trade-Offs Across Diverse Cognitive and Linguistic Profiles"
- **UMAP '26**
  "Personalizing Font Size Normalization: Linguistic Background Shapes Which Font Attributes Matter"
- **CHI '26**
  "Reading with Diversity in Mind: Pupillometry and Typography Towards Inclusive Design for ADHD Readers"
  "REARS: An Interface for Browser-Based Eye-Tracking in Remote Readability Studies"
  "Different Font Attributes Influence English Readers' Perception of Font Size Across Age Groups"
  "One Reader, Two Reading Profiles: Language-Dependent Dyslexia and Reading Behaviors in English-Spanish Readers"

Submissions:

"METaD: A Human-Centric Framework to Describe Maintaining Evolving Tabular Datasets"
"ESL and Non-ESL Readers Across Cognitive Styles Read AI-Summarized Voter Pamphlets Slower"
"Breaking Word Barriers: What Makes Digital Reading Harder for Readers with and without Dyslexia"

- Conducting comprehensive research on the impact of font typography on reading patterns across cognitively and linguistically diverse populations.
- Designing and implementing experiments to gather data on visual attention and cognitive load during reading tasks using eye tracking and pupillometry.
- Developing and applying various statistical analysis methods to interpret findings and evaluate readability factors.
- Building online readability tools – ReadGEN: Personalized text to JPG conversion for other researchers, REARS: Principles of webcam based eye-tracking and pupillometry remote readability studies, Votelayout: 2d Web-based layout designer to study pathing/foot traffic design principles.

Graduate Administrative Assistant, University of Rhode Island — [01/2026—current]

Institute for AI and Computational Research – IACR

- Leading several research projects, offering support and training sessions to researchers.
- Helping prepare documentation, workshops and video tutorials.
- Helping in migrating research computing workflows to new computational systems made accessible via the MGH-PCC.
- Serving as a communication channel (liaison) between researchers and the IT Research Computing team.

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Rhode Island — [01/2025—12/2025]

Voting Layout Designer - votelayout.app

- Co-designed, developed, and deployed an online voting-space layout designer for election officials.
- Implemented automated ADA compliance checks and AI-assisted path planning for accessible voter flow.
- Led full-stack development using Svelte, TypeScript, and Rust.
- Managed and mentored developers, providing architectural guidance and code reviews.
- Oversaw deployment and maintenance; preparing the project for open-source release.
- Running a design principles of pathing/traffic flows study.

Course Instructor, University of Rhode Island — [01/2025—05/2025]

CSC412 - Operating Systems and Networks.

- Delivered lectures and hands-on lab sessions for undergraduate and graduate students in Computer Science.
- Developed course materials, including assignments and labs, to enhance student learning and foster critical thinking.
- Provided constructive feedback to help students improve their understanding and performance in the subject.
- Course evaluations yielded a 77% response rate and an average score of 4.17 on a 5-point scale.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Rhode Island **[09/2022—12/2025]**

Classes: CSC440 - Design and Analysis of Algorithms (x3), CSC340 - Applied Combinatorics (x3), CSC200 - Problem Solving For Science and Engineering (x2), CSC104 - Analytical Thinking.

- Served as a TA for 8 different courses, ranging from introductory to advanced theoretical and systems classes.
- Created assignments and assignment grading keys.
- Conducted weekly labs, held office hours, help hours and tutorial sessions.
- Engineered automated grading systems.
- Proctored exams and maintained class grade records.

Full-Stack Developer, Ritech International AG **[07/2021—05/2022]**

Esme Learning

- Developed reusable website template pages utilizing HTML, SCSS, Liquid (Shopify), Python, and JavaScript, resulting in optimized, faster-loading landing pages.
- Orchestrated the creation and deployment of an RDS SQL Server database on AWS, and crafted an API in Python for seamless backend-to-frontend integration, resulting in faster API response times.
- Incorporate pre-existing data into the new database.
- Conducted SCSS factorization and optimization by removing redundant styles from existing templates.
- Led a comprehensive SEO optimization and enhancement initiative, resulting in a 15% increase in customer reach from popular search engines.

Skills

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Svelte, JavaScript, Typescript, C++, C, Go, Java, Asteroid, BASH
- **Other**: Numpy, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Matplotlib, HTML, CSS/SASS/SCSS, Liquid, React.js, NodeJS, MongoDB, SQL, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Albanian (native), English (fluent)